

Cesar Garcia

Founding Designer - Lead Product Designer

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SUMMARY

Twice a founding designer, an engineer by training, AI-native end to end: design, building, shipping. I turn high-stakes technical constraints into proven, unique, simple solutions, tuned to human behaviour. 200M+ users across payments, pensions, crypto, financial crime, consumer and SaaS.

SKILLS

Design	Design systems, Product strategy, User research, Prototyping, Information architecture, Design leadership and hiring, Data-led design, iOS, Android and web
Domains	Payments, Cryptocurrency and Web3, Digital wallets, KYC / AML, Financial crime compliance, Pensions, Credit
Tools	Figma, Claude Code, OpenAI Codex, AI-assisted prototyping and engineering
Roles	Founding designer, design lead, or hands-on individual contributor at staff / principal scope

EXPERIENCE

Selected case studies at cesarxdesign.com ↗

Co-Founder, DONE ↗ (Side project, Mar 2018 - Present)

Consumer fitness app, three versions in eight years. Led product strategy and UX/UI. Launched March 2020, earning a 5.0 App Store rating within two months, just before every gym on earth went into lockdown. Now building it solo, with AI covering the engineering that once took two people, and a relaunch set for 2026.

Product Design Lead, Confirmit ↗ (Oct 2025 - Jun 2026)

First designer at a crypto payments processor moving \$750M a year. Owned the full buyer-and-merchant surface plus brand, built the design system from scratch, and moved design to the front of product with the CPO. Redesigned a checkout stuck at 9% success, to 43% in key markets and 27% overall, adding \$135M a year in converted payments with zero backend changes. Launched Confirmit Subscriptions with Circle and Solana, the first recurring crypto payments product of its kind. That success pulled Confirmit upmarket, accelerating its shift to API-first enterprise clients.

Lead Product Designer, Trust Wallet (Apr 2025 - Sep 2025)

Lead designer on the Banking/Fiat Squad, the bridge between traditional money and crypto, 200M+ users. Rebuilt the new-wallet and import flows and overhauled fiat-to-crypto funding, turning serious technical complexity into something users could trust. Built on Binance's design framework, cross-functional with product, engineering and data. Shipped.

Independent Consulting (Sep 2024 - Mar 2025)

Early-stage startups. At BLKBOX.ai (AI creative testing), ran a full UX audit and worked with the CTO to scope what engineering could ship, including a Super Bowl NFL campaign producing AI ads across markets. At ShopLevers, led discovery and prototyping for an AI purchase-order and inventory dashboard, delivering a shippable product and design system.

Head of Design and Product Owner, Mara ↗ (Nov 2022 - Aug 2024)

Crypto/fiat wallet for African markets, Coinbase as lead investor. Ran three cross-functional teams across design, engineering and support, presenting strategy directly to investors. Full end-to-end redesign in under a month, shipping to 24M users. Cut onboarding by 89%, moving KYC and other verifications to the point of need: completion rose from 12% to 88%, adding 20M users and saving \$6.9M a year.

Founding Designer, Cable ↗ (Jul 2021 - Oct 2022)

First designer at the only financial-crime and AML compliance startup with a live product. Turned it from reactive, client-driven builds into a coherent, UX-led compliance suite, mature enough to earn its keep and land the product's first real sale.

Director of Design, Orbis Pay (Jun 2020 - May 2021)

Consultant to full-time, expanding into brand and marketing alongside product. Owned the full product end-to-end, from earned-advance and savings flows to onboarding, aligning Sales, Engineering, Legal and Customer Success across complex employer-payroll integrations.

Founding Designer, Penfold ↗ (Jun 2019 - May 2020)

First hire, alongside the co-founders and one developer. Took the proof of concept to a live app onboarding real customers in one week, in time for the funding round, then built a modular design system that halved engineering work. I refocused the product on existing pension holders, driving 6x signups and GBP 4M in first-year AUM.

Head of Product Design, Starcount ↗ (May 2017 - May 2019)

First product designer; grew the function into a four-person team within months. Hit a GBP 1M first-year revenue target in 91 days across two product lines launched from scratch and one revived, centred on an audience-intelligence tool built with Twitter and Royal Mail, the first deal of its kind.

Earlier (2006 - 2017)

Lead Designer, VesselsValue (brand from scratch, direct to CEO); Head of Design, Gforce Networks (team of 12; games, apps, brand); Designer, Leo Burnett (Apple, Samsung, Mercedes, Vodafone; rebranded Lisbon's commuter rail); Software Engineer, Pfizer (CRM migration with Accenture, UK and India).

EDUCATION

Instituto Superior Tecnico, Computer Science

Lisbon, Portugal - Remote across Europe - Portuguese (EU) citizen